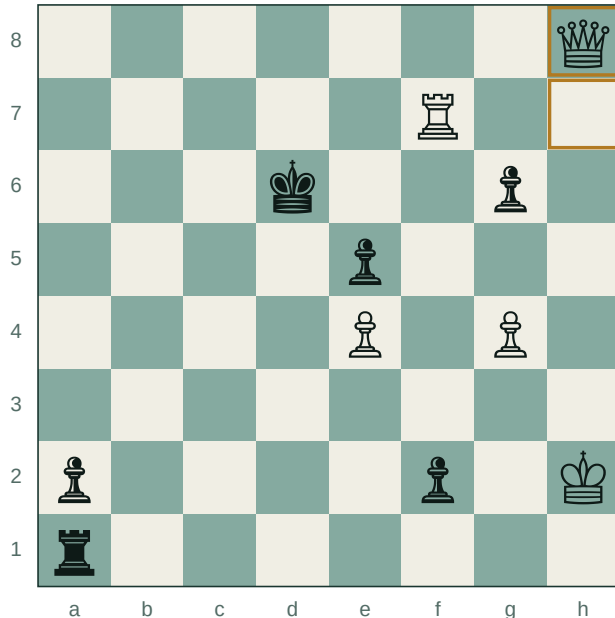


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 46

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 46.h8=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

46...Rh1+ 47. Kxh1 a1=Q+ 48. Kg2 Qg1+

46...Rh1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47.Kxh1**.

47...a1=Q+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **48.Kg2**.

48...Qg1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -7 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on h8 and rook on f7. Check for tactical protection.